

GUJARAT ORIGIN

Paneer Bhurji

Gujarati-Style Scrambled Paneer
A Quick, Gently Sweet Modern Favorite

AUTHENTIC RECIPE · STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE · PRINTABLE DIGITAL COOKBOOK

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Paneer Bhurji

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ABOUT THIS BOOK

Paneer Bhurji

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DISCLAIMER

Nutrition values are estimates. Cooking times vary with equipment and ingredients. Readers with allergies or dietary restrictions should check every ingredient label before cooking.

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THE STORY BEHIND THE DISH

A Modern Dish Wearing a Gujarati Accent

Paneer bhurji — crumbled paneer scrambled with onions, tomatoes, and spices, similar in spirit to a savory egg scramble — is a relatively modern addition to Indian home cooking generally, popularized as paneer became more widely available and affordable across the country in recent decades. Gujarati households have adopted the dish enthusiastically, giving it their own characteristic accent along the way.

The Gujarati version tends to be gentler and slightly sweeter than the more robustly spiced Punjabi-style paneer bhurji found elsewhere in Indian cooking, with a touch of sugar working alongside the tomatoes and onions to create the same familiar sweet-savory balance found throughout this collection. It's also commonly built with more finely chopped vegetables — capsicum, carrot, or peas — reflecting a Gujarati preference for incorporating vegetables generously into protein dishes.

As a quick, protein-rich dish that comes together in well under twenty minutes, paneer bhurji has found a natural home in busy modern Gujarati households, often packed into lunchboxes, stuffed into sandwiches, or served simply with roti — a genuinely contemporary dish that nonetheless carries an unmistakably Gujarati flavor profile.

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THE STORY BEHIND THE DISH

A Modern Dish Wearing a Gujarati Accent, continued

CULTURAL NOTES & OCCASIONS

A relatively modern dish within Indian cooking generally, gaining popularity as paneer became more widely available and affordable across the country. The Gujarati version is characteristically gentler and slightly sweeter than more robustly spiced regional variations. Reflects a Gujarati preference for incorporating vegetables generously into protein-based dishes. Popular as a quick lunchbox filling, sandwich stuffing, or simple side, reflecting contemporary busy household cooking.

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AT A GLANCE

Equipment & preparation

10m	15m	4	Easy
ACTIVE PREP	COOK TIME	SERVINGS	DIFFICULTY

Recommended equipment

- Kadai or wide pan
- Wooden spoon

STORAGE & MAKE-AHEAD

Paneer bhurji keeps refrigerated for up to 2 days, best enjoyed fresh as paneer's texture is at its best shortly after cooking. It doesn't freeze particularly well, given paneer's tendency to turn rubbery after freezing and thawing.

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WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Ingredients

For the dish

INGREDIENT	US	METRIC	INDIAN
Paneer, crumbled	300 g	300 g	300 g
Oil	2 tbsp	30 ml	2 chammach
Cumin seeds	1 tsp	4 g	1 chammach
Onion, finely chopped	1 medium	100 g	1 medium
Capsicum (bell pepper), finely chopped	½ cup	60 g	½ katori
Carrot, finely chopped — optional	¼ cup	30 g	¼ katori
Tomato, finely chopped	1 medium	100 g	1 medium
Ginger-green chili paste	1 tsp	5 g	1 chammach
Turmeric powder	¼ tsp	1 g	¼ chammach
Red chili powder	½ tsp	1.5 g	½ chammach
Sugar	½ tsp	2 g	½ chammach
Salt	¾ tsp	4.5 g	to taste
Fresh coriander, chopped, for garnish	2 tbsp	8 g	2 tbsp
Lemon juice	1 tsp	5 ml	1 chammach

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WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Ingredients, continued

SUBSTITUTIONS & SOURCING

Fresh, soft paneer crumbles best and gives the ideal texture; if using store-bought paneer that feels firm, soak it briefly in warm water to soften before crumbling. Any combination of finely chopped vegetables works well beyond what's listed — this dish is flexible and forgiving, making it easy to adapt to what's on hand.

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STEP BY STEP · STEP-BY-STEP

Making Paneer Bhurji

01 TEMPER THE CUMIN

Heat oil in a kadai and add cumin seeds, letting them sizzle for a few seconds.

02 SAUTÉ THE VEGETABLES

Add the chopped onion and sauté until translucent, about 4–5 minutes. Add the capsicum and carrot if using, cooking for another 3–4 minutes until slightly softened.



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STEP BY STEP · STEP-BY-STEP

Making Paneer Bhurji, continued

03 ADD TOMATO AND SPICES

Add the chopped tomato, ginger-green chili paste, turmeric, and chili powder. Cook for 4–5 minutes, until the tomato softens and the mixture comes together.

04 ADD THE PANEER

Add the crumbled paneer, sugar, and salt, gently folding to combine without over-mixing. Cook for 4–5 minutes, just until the paneer is warmed through and coated in the spiced vegetable mixture.

Chef tip. fold gently rather than stirring vigorously — you want to combine the paneer with the masala without breaking it down into an overly fine texture.

05 FINISH AND SERVE

Stir in the fresh coriander and lemon juice just before serving.

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STEP BY STEP · STEP-BY-STEP

Making Paneer Bhurji, continued



MISTAKE TO AVOID

Overcooking the paneer once it's added makes it turn tough and rubbery. Keep the final cooking time brief — just enough to warm through and absorb the spices.

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SERVING & PAIRING

How to serve



Traditional Style

- Served with roti or as a filling for sandwiches and wraps.
- A popular quick lunchbox item in busy Gujarati households.

Family Style

- A fast, protein-rich weeknight dish alongside rice or roti.

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How to serve, continued

Modern Pairing

- Works well as a filling for toasted sandwiches or as a topping for toast, reflecting its contemporary, versatile role.

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RESTAURANT-GRADE TRICKS

Chef secrets

Getting the Texture Right

- Gentle folding, rather than vigorous stirring, keeps the paneer from breaking down into an unpleasantly fine, mushy texture.
- A brief final cooking time is key — paneer bhurji should feel just warmed through, not extensively cooked.

Make-Ahead & Meal Prep

- Chop all vegetables ahead of time to make this an even quicker dish when you're ready to cook.
- Best made fresh close to serving, given how quickly it comes together and how much fresher paneer tastes right after cooking.

RESTAURANT TRICK

Some cooks add a small pinch of garam masala at the very end for extra warmth, a modern touch that complements the dish's gentle base spicing.

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BONUS CONTENT

Nutrition, variations & FAQ

APPROXIMATE NUTRITION, PER SERVING

240 kcal	13 g	8 g	17 g	2 g
CALORIES	PROTEIN	CARBOHYDRATES	FAT	FIBER

Estimates only; actual values vary with oil and portion size.

ALLERGEN GUIDE

Contains, based on the ingredient list: Dairy. Check packaged spices and asafoetida, which may contain wheat, and verify against your own ingredients.

REGIONAL VARIATIONS

Gujarati-Style Paneer Bhurji	the mild, gently sweet version featured here.
Paneer Bhurji Sandwich	the same mixture used as a hearty, protein-rich sandwich filling.
Paneer Bhurji with Peas	some households add green peas for extra color and texture.

Can I use tofu instead of paneer?

Yes, crumbled firm tofu works as a substitute, though the flavor and texture will differ somewhat from traditional paneer.

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BONUS CONTENT

Nutrition, variations & FAQ, continued

Why did my paneer turn rubbery?

Almost always overcooking after the paneer is added. Keep the final cooking time brief, just enough to warm through.

Is this dish very spicy?

No — it's mild and gently sweet, reflecting the characteristic Gujarati approach even to a relatively modern dish like this.

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REFERENCE

Ingredient glossary



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REFERENCE

Ingredient glossary, continued

GLOSSARY

Bhurji	a scrambled-style preparation, commonly applied to eggs or paneer.
Paneer	fresh, non-melting Indian cheese made from curdled milk, the base of this dish.
Kanda	Gujarati for onion, a key aromatic in this dish.
Marcha	Gujarati for chili, used here in paste form with ginger.

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PRINTABLE RECIPE CARD

Paneer Bhurji

10m	15m
ACTIVE PREP	COOK TIME
4	Easy
SERVINGS	DIFFICULTY

DISH

Paneer	300 g
Oil	30 ml
Cumin seeds	4 g
Onion	100 g
Capsicum	60 g
Carrot	30 g
Tomato	100 g
Ginger-green chili paste	5 g
Turmeric powder	1 g
Red chili powder	1.5 g
Sugar	2 g
Salt	4.5 g
Fresh coriander	8 g
Lemon juice	5 ml

METHOD

01 **Temper the cumin.** Heat oil in a kadai and add cumin seeds, letting them sizzle for a few seconds.

02 **Sauté the vegetables.** Add the chopped onion and sauté until translucent, about 4–5 minutes.

03 **Add tomato and spices.** Add the chopped tomato, ginger-green chili paste, turmeric, and chili powder.

04 **Add the paneer.** Add the crumbled paneer, sugar, and salt, gently folding to combine without over-mixing.

05 **Finish and serve.** Stir in the fresh coriander and lemon juice just before serving.

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BEFORE YOU SHOP

Shopping list

☐ Paneer	300 g	☐ Oil	30 ml
☐ Cumin seeds	4 g	☐ Onion	100 g
☐ Capsicum	60 g	☐ Carrot	30 g
☐ Tomato	100 g	☐ Ginger-green chili paste	5 g
☐ Turmeric powder	1 g	☐ Red chili powder	1.5 g
☐ Sugar	2 g	☐ Salt	4.5 g
☐ Fresh coriander	8 g	☐ Lemon juice	5 ml

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